A Weapon Bound to Malice

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/33076357.

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Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018), Destiny (Video Games)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
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by DeltaFell

Summary

Catra really didn't think she would ever see Adora again, but then she did. Adora came, well, not back, but all the way out here for her. Could she really have a second chance? After everything that she did? After everything he pushed her to do?

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

With a loud crash, Catra woke up. She had been flung from her mattress as the ship shook violently from an impact.

She stood shakily, and barely managed to brace herself before another impact rattled the ship. Catra opened her door and staggered out into the hallway. She walked down the hallway, pausing every so often to keep her balance when the ship shook. After some mild tribulation, she reached the control room.

"Okay, what the hell is going on?"

Before Catra was a scene of utter madness. Bow sat in the command chair, waving his arms about inside a large holographic ball, Adora was shouting at the ship, and Entrapta seemed to be having entirely too much fun for someone making repairs and putting out fires.

A very frazzled Adora turned around to face Catra. "Pirates! Shooting! Asteroid field!" Adora quickly turned back to the ship.

"Okay, does anybody care to translate that for me?"

"Not too long after we left the planet where we picked you up, this huge ship showed up! It started deploying other, smaller ships that began to chase us. These small ships started firing at us, and when we couldn't shake them, we got to fly into this asteroid belt

to escape!" Entrapta was far too excited for this early in the morning, much less the ongoing circumstances.

"Wait, wait, got to?! Entrapta, what?"

"Well, I wanted to explore it much earlier - just think of all the data we could gather if we could examine an asteroid belt - but Bow didn't want to. But when these ships showed up, and started firing, we didn't have a choice!"

Catra examined the display of the ships attacking them. Three ships, all red against the void. The main body was diamond shaped, with a series of lower decks extending beneath the main body to form a t-like shape. On each side of the ship sat rounded thrusters, and at the bottom of the ship sat a large gun.

"I don't think these are pirates, Adora, they look too regular for that. They all have the same paint job, even. Whatever they are, they're well organized."

Privately, Catra thought the architecture resembled that of the ship she was in during that second reflection, but she wasn't ready to voice those thoughts.

The ships' guns followed their movement precisely, even through the asteroid field.

“But how do they keep finding us?” Bow asked. “They shouldn’t have been able to find us in here!”

Entrapta chimed in, “Maybe it’s the strange signal I’ve been picking up. It only started showing up after we went in for Catra.”

“What are you saying,” Catra said, stepping towards Entrapta, “that it’s my fault somehow? That I’m to blame?”

“What? No, of course not, there’s far too many variables to account for to say such a thing.”

Catra internally heaved a sigh of relief, although she was quite confused. Why wouldn’t Entrapta be using her position to get rid of her? She had been fucking terrible to Entrapta, back in the Horde.

“This way, I think I’ve locked down what was sending that signal!” Entrapta rushed out of the control room.

Curious, Catra and Adora followed Entrapta out of the control room.

Entrapta darted down the hallway, face down in her datapad. Every so often, she would stop, tap a few buttons and look around her before continuing through the corridor.

“Hmm, is it in here? I think it's in here,” Entrapta muttered to herself.

Entrapta opened the door to her left, which, as Catra caught up to her, she realized was her room.

“Hey, I thought you said it wasn’t my fault!”

“Actually, I only said there were too many variables unaccounted for to say then. Also, I don’t think it would be your fault, anyways. It’s been giving off the signal this whole time, which makes me think it's some intrinsic property of the sword, and you clearly don’t like holding it, maybe the texture? The texture looks like it might be unpleasant. Why don’t you like the sword, I thought you liked weapons?”

“I- what, no it’s not the texture, Entrapta. I - when I hold it, I can hear a voice speaking to me, okay? I’m not crazy, I swear!”

Entrapta tilted her head and looked at Catra. She pulled out her recorder with one pigtail. “Fascinating, tell me more. Have you ever heard other voices, or heard the voices at other times? Has anyone else heard these voices? Can I touch it and see if I hear the voices?”

“No, Entrapta, you can’t touch it. The voice that I hear, it pushes on the worst parts of you, making you more paranoid, more jealous, more prone to your worst desires. It nearly destroyed me. I can’t let it get to anyone else.”

“Oh well, we’ll have to destroy it anyway. I think if we destroy it, it should stop giving off that signal.”

“You think?”

“Yeah, I can’t be completely certain of course, this is uncharted territory after all! Isn’t it just so exciting?”

“That’s certainly one word for it, yes. Look, if we’re going to destroy it, can I be the one to break the blade? It’s caused me enough trouble, I think I deserve to cause it some too.”

“Okay, just hand the remnants to me for disposal.”

Catra felt strangely reluctant to destroy the sword, but she knew it must happen. If Entrapta said it might work, then it probably would. She wasn’t often wrong. Even though she felt some strange attachment to the accursed thing, Catra wouldn’t let that stop her.

Catra grabbed the sword, and the voice returned, tumultuous. It spewed forth a storm within her mind, bringing Catra to her

knees. If before it felt like fingertips on the surface of her mind, now it felt like those same fingers were reaching into her brain and strangling it. Catra cried out in pain as images flashed before her eyes.

"Catra!" Adora cried out.

That was new, when did Adora get here? It didn't matter, Catra had to do this, had to withstand the whispers and shatter the sword to get them out of here. She began to stand, but then she recognized the images flashing before her eyes. It was Etheria, falling to Oryx's control. Black goo, speckled with the light of stars covered the Fright Zone. Hive Tombships hovered over Brightmoon. Thralls and Acolytes crawled through the Whispering Woods.

"I'm getting images from the sword. It - it looks like Oryx is conquering Etheria. But it's more than just conquering, he's Taking them, he's going to Take them all!" Catra screamed in anguish, and brought the sword down upon the deck.

For an instant it held, resistant to the forces acting upon it, but the sword quickly shattered into a dozen pieces. As they scattered, a tortured wail could be heard.

Entrapta had been fidgeting with one of their trackerpads, trying to get a signal back to Etheria, but Catra supposed she must have

gotten distracted with some of the wiring underneath one of Darla's many consoles, as that's what she seemed to be doing.

A sudden noise split across the deck, causing Catra to jump. What the hell was that noise? She immediately turned her head towards the doorway, but nothing was there. Behind her, Entrapta cackled excitedly.

"We've got a signal, haha!"

The screen on the trackerpad crackled to life, revealing Flower Girl - no, Perfuma. Perfuma looked terrible. Her hair was in disarray, and her outfit - some kind of fancy party dress - was in shambles, even torn in some places.

"Entrapta, whatever you do, don't come back to Etheria. It's a trap, Oryx's ships are blockading Etheria! What's worse - what's worse is he can do something to you, control you, make you turn."

Drawn in by the commotion, Adora and Bow entered the control room and approach the trackerpad. Perfuma saw Adora in the camera, and frantically addressed her, "Adora under no circumstances can you come back to Etheria, do you understand me? It's far too dangerous!. He's …"

Perfuma's transmission cut off with a burst of static. The sudden silence weighed heavily upon the room.

"Well, obviously we're going anyways, right?" Bow said, awkwardly attempting to fill the silence.

"No, are you crazy? You heard what she said, right? He's got a blockade around Etheria - there's no way we'd make it though," Catra said. She slumped slightly. "We'd be dead before we even reached the atmosphere, if he didn't Take us the moment he saw our ship."

"We can't just abandon Etheria! Everybody's counting on us to beat him!"

"No, they're counting on you. I hardly think anybody on Etheria wants to see me, not after everything that I did."

"C'mon Catra, we came out here just to save you."

"Not everyone's as friendly as you, Bow. Trust me, nobody wants me."

Upset, Catra stormed out of the control room. She really didn't want to be thinking anymore about where all her mistakes had led her.

“AHAHA! Everyone, come quick!” Entrapta’s voice blared through speakers outside Catra’s room, startling her.

Reluctantly, Catra crawled out from her blanket pile and stood up. If she didn’t come and see whatever it was Entrapta was up to, Catra suspected that Entrapta would come and grab her anyway.

In the hallway, Catra passed Adora, who gave her a small smile. Catra looked away. There was no way Adora could like Catra, not in the same way Catra liked her. Catra had done too much, hurt Adora too many times.

“So, I noticed a strange signal coming from a planet along our route back to Etheria, and when I deviated our course slightly to get a better lock, I saw something incredible! I believe that this planet, Krytis, was once the site of a Horde occupation!”

“Wait, what?” Adora and Bow asked in unison.

“Ohh. I must’ve forgotten to mention that part. When I was working with Hordak, he mentioned that he was a clone in a vast galactic empire. He wanted to build a portal to contact the Horde’s ruler, Horde Prime, but then things happened and well, we never got around to it. Anywho, if there’s Horde tech down there, we might be able to find something we could use against Oryx! Wouldn’t that just be so awesome?”

Adora, Bow, and Glimmer blinked repeatedly at the tidal wave of new information.

"Okay, so what, do we just go and land then? Do you know where the tech is, exactly?" Adora asked.

"Ah, hmmm. I don't exactly know where it is, but I have a rough location. The signal is still pretty weak, even this close, so we'll probably have to look around for a little bit. It'll be like a scavenger hunt! Ohhh just imagine all the things we could learn. So much potential data!"

Entrapta had run off with Bow and Glimmer in one direction, suggesting that Catra and Adora search the nearby cave systems to see if the source was subterranean. That meant now, Catra and Adora were alone, together, crawling through tight spaces. Catra had to wonder if Entrapta knew what she was doing, and was trying to help Catra, or if she simply didn't realize how pairing Catra and Adora would turn out. Catra just knew this was going to end in tears.

Adora was obviously trying to stay close to her. Why the hell would she come so far to rescue her if she didn't trust her? It's not like the distrust wasn't earned, Catra knew she had definitely earned that. But if you didn't trust someone enough to give them a fucking foot of space, then why bother going so far to save them in the first place?

Catra heard a strange noise from the cavern ahead, and stopped suddenly. Of course, Adora, following her tighter than her own shadow, didn't manage to stop in time and barreled them both into the next cavern.

"What the fuck, Adora? I can get that you don't trust me, really, I do. But if this was going to be how you treated me, then why did you come for me? I know you hate me. So why go all this way, risk everyone on Etheria, for me?"

"It's not that I don't trust you, Catra."

"Then what is it?"

"I'm concerned for you. We grew up together, remember? I can tell you're hurting, Catra. I want to help, but I don't know how. I never hated you. I don't think I would know how to. We came back because everyone deserves a second chance."

"After everything I've done? Are you really saying I deserve a second chance?"

"Yes, Catra. You started all this, anyways. You saved Glimmer from Oryx, at great risk to yourself. Very princess-y behaviour."

Adora reached out to Catra and held her hands. Catra found herself looking into Adora's eyes. Before anything further could

happen, however, the sharp crack of falling rock interrupted them.

"What the fuck was that?" Catra said. She could feel her tail bristle and her hair stand on end. Catra looked around the cavern to no avail. There was nothing there, no clouds of dust or a fresh pile of rubble. Catra took a tentative step forwards into the cavern.

"Catra, what are you-" Adora trailed off as something caught her attention.

Catra turned around, and saw a rather large purple being standing behind her. She leapt forward, taking it down. There was no way she was going to let it get Adora, not after what Adora had just told her. Catra pushed down how she felt about what Adora said. About how Adora looked. About what they were doing.

It didn't matter anyways. She didn't have a future back on Etheria. No matter what Adora said, Catra knew what would really happen.

The strange being rolled out from underneath her, stood, and then changed. They turned from a bipedal being with their head coated in a spectral wreath into a big purple cat with a spectral mane. Their mane was blue for a second, before it spiked out and became red.

The strange cat began circling Catra, growling.

"Adora? Maybe a little help here?"

"What do you want me to do, Catra? I still don't have She-Ra back all the way!"

"Then what the hell was the whole She-Ra smash thing back in the Vault?"

"Well," Adora blushed heavily," I can only really do it when you're in danger, I think."

"Well I'm very much in danger!"

The big cat growled at Catra's distressed tone.

"She-Ra seems to disagree!"

Catra had an idea when Adora said that. It was a really stupid idea, but all the ideas these idiots had were stupid ones, and they managed to beat the Horde back, so maybe it was worth trying. If She-Ra felt that she wasn't in danger, then as dumb as it seemed, maybe she wasn't. What would happen, she wondered, if she reached out and touched them?

So Catra took a leap of faith, and stretched out her hand to touch them on the snout. Instantly they shrank, their spiky red mane becoming calm and blue once more.

They began to glow a bright blue, and Catra had to shut her eyes. Eventually, the glow lessened, and Catra could open her eyes again. They were nuzzling their head against her palm. Adora shifted behind her, and they quickly disappeared from view.

After Adora froze, and a few fraught seconds, they reappeared, mewling.

“You’ve been touched by one such as Prime, haven’t you?” they said.

“Uh, Adora? Can you hear them talking? Please tell me you can hear them talking. I don’t want another voice in my head.”

“I can hear them, but I can’t understand them.”

“Oh great.”

“It does not quite stink the same, but I can tell it was similar.” They licked her palm. “Do not worry, kitten, I will protect you now. He cannot hurt you anymore.”

“I don’t need protecting! I can protect myself! Besides, I have Adora. She looks out for me, and I look out for her.”

They snorted, “I am sufficient. But I suppose you may keep your First One. Adora is an acceptable choice, for a First One.”

“Oh great, they’ve got an ego. Hey, what’s your name anyways?”

“My name is Melog, kitten.”

“Well,” Catra laughed, “alright then Melog. C’mon, we should introduce you to our friends.”

Behind Catra, Adora was beaming.

“No Entrapta, we can’t just adopt whatever life forms we find here, especially not a clone of Hordak!” shouted Glimmer.

“But we broke him! We can’t just leave him here! Besides, Catra got to adopt a life form!”

“What?”

“Yeah look at this! There are three heat signatures walking up to us! Since this place is basically abandoned, that has to be Adora, Catra, and Catra’s new friend!”

“How do you know it's Catra and Adora, and how do you know Catra’s even the one who adopted the third one?”

“Oh, that’s simple! I was able to identify Catra and Adora’s thermal signatures before they left and these are the same ones! As for why I know it’s Catra who did the adopting, well that’s simple.The new heat signature has been keeping close to Catra the whole time.”

“Why didn’t you tell us?” Glimmer demanded.

“I just did,” replied Entrapta.

Catra smiled as Adora, Melog and herself came over the hill and into the little encampment around Darla that had been set up.

“Hey Sparkles,” Catra said as Melog dropped their invisibility.

Much to Catra’s satisfaction, Glimmer jumped.

“So, I think I have a way to get us back to Etheria without getting blasted out of the sky.”

Catra and Adora were eating a meal in Catra’s room, with Melog napping nearby.

It really didn’t taste all that great, Catra had eaten better contraband in the Fright Zone with Scorpia and Entrapta, but she was with Adora now. That made it all better, more than it could have been without her.

Adora’s eyes flashed with magic as she laughed, and Catra tried to fight the way that made her feel. She couldn’t afford to feel that way. Not with what it would do to Adora when she was gone.

Catra stood on the bridge nervously as they approached Oryx’s fleet. Entrapta had assured her that Melog’s stealth would work, but it was still nerve-wracking, sitting here, unable to do anything.

“It will work, kitten. Do not fret yourself. Magic has always been beyond the understanding of ones such as he.”

Adora reached out and wrapped one arm around Catra, comforting her. Adora always knew how she felt, and she didn't even need some special magic bond to do that.

Darla flew in without a trace. Oryx's fleets never even shifted in their positions.

When they got to Etheria, they found the Rebellion crushed. Scorpia, Mermista, Micah, Spinnerella and many, many others were all gone. Taken by Oryx. Catra could hear the impact, in the dead silence in the day and the muffled sobs in the night.

Catra began to wonder if her actions at the head of the Horde had caused anything like this. It was awful, the anguish that was in the air. Even in the eerie setting of the ruins of a long dead civilization - ruins that Oryx had seemed unable to penetrate, making these ruins their last bastion - the grief was palpable.

Even though she knew it would only make matters worse in the end, Catra began to seek Adora out on these days. Being around Adora helped with all the suffering, and the knowledge that ultimately, it was all her fault.

How could Adora tolerate her presence? Catra couldn't even stand herself anymore.

Catra hated the fucking plan. Once again, Adora was ignoring what Adora wanted in favor of what everyone else wanted. Her fucking hero complex had her sacrificing herself to save the world. But did she even stop to consider if the world wouldn't be one worth living in without her?

So she ran out here to sulk. If Adora was going to kill herself to save the world then she didn't want to be there to see it. She supposed she should get packing. Nobody was going to want her around Bright Moon without Adora there to protect her.

As she grabbed her bag and stood up she heard Melog.

"You know what she would do for you kitten. Would you not do the same for her?"

"Of course I would! But if she's just going to charge off and get herself killed, what says I have to be there to watch it happen?"

Catra turned, and walked through the First Ones ruin that had been serving as their hideout while they planned their attack on Oryx. When she stepped on something abnormally cold, Catra stopped and looked down. She jumped back. She had been standing on some of that Taken goo from Oryx's ship.

Catra quickly checked her feet to see if any of it had gotten onto her. Her feet fortunately remained untainted. Catra felt cold as she realized what this could mean. If the First Ones ruins were no longer safe, if he could infiltrate them then he might be able to Take Adora, or She-Ra, or he might know their plans.

This was bad. This was very bad.

Catra turned and sprinted out of the ruins. She had to get to Adora before it was too late.

Catra found them outside some Hive spire that had been landed on Etheria to act as some sort of headquarters for the invasion. Adora was on her knees before Oryx, not kneeling, but exhausted. Catra had no idea how long she'd been battling him, but this couldn't be good. Adora never got too tired as She-Ra.

Then she saw Oryx gathering Taken energy in his hand. He was going to Take Adora. She had to stop him.

Catra jumped out, interposing herself between Oryx and Adora. "No, you don't get to hurt her, asshole!"

Oryx cocked his head, but dissipated the energy.

“It is a shame that you have fallen so far, Little One. It is of no matter, you are weak.” Oryx drew his sword and swung down.

Catra closed her eyes. She thought of Adora, her smile, her laugh, her stupid hair poof. Catra thought of her storm-grey eyes, she thought of the cute face Adora made when she was thinking really hard. Aw hell, she thought, there’s no harm admitting it now. She loved Adora. She always had, even when she tried to hate her, even when she hated herself, she could only ever love Adora.

There was the clang of chitin on metal. Catra opened her eyes to find that there was a sword in front of her, but it wasn’t the Sword of Protection. Catra trailed her eyes down its length, until she saw a familiar chitinous handle held in her own hands. It was the sword Oryx had given her, but reforged for a new purpose.

Catra pushed, and shoved Oryx’s sword away.

“No. I’m not weak. You took me, and bent me, warped me, made me a weapon bound to malice. That ends today. Nothing you did, nothing Shadow Weaver, or even myself ever did could break my love for Adora. I choose to bind myself and this weapon to my love. You can’t have her, and you definitely can’t have my fucking love for her. So feel free to screw off, and never come back.”

Catra moved the sword into a position she had often seen Adora hold the Sword of Protection in, hoping she looked like she knew what she was doing. Behind her, Catra heard a noise. Adora was beginning to stand up, leaning on her sword.

“You, you love me, Catra?” Adora’s voice was as unsteady as her stance.

“Of course I do, dummy. Now let’s kick his ass and save Etheria.”

Adora stood still for a moment.

“I,” Adora winced, as if just talking was painful, “ I love you too Catra.”

Catra felt tears budding in her eyes. She stooped low to help Adora stand up all the way and kissed her.

“Now, let’s go get him, okay?”

Adora smiled, “For the honor of Grayskull!”

The two charged Oryx, and swung both of their swords through his chitin.

End Notes

It's finally over. The series that started with a conversation about parallels between Destiny and SPOP back in like december/january is over. This was a pretty big thing for me, SPOP and Destiny being probably my two favorite works of fiction.

All of my readers touch my heart, but there's some very specific people I should thank. Steamed, for facilitating this whole series and spending two hours with me classifying cabal ships, only for it to end up being like two lines lmao. Inthretis actually got me thinking of Forever and a Blade beyond the first installment (no Momtra this time around). Zeroan just being an all around wonderful human being.

I'm trying to post on Fridays now, so you can expect something new then, although I'm not certain what it will be lol. Again, thanks for reading, it really makes my day.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!